

VENKATA VARA PRASAD BANDARU

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- Strategic Leader and QE Architect with over 18 years of experience leading comprehensive quality assurance strategies, developing robust test automation frameworks, and implementing KPIs and metrics to drive continuous improvement and successfully deliver high-impact projects across the Fintech, Consumer Products, and Software Services sectors.
- Proficient in designing and developing robust test automation frameworks using automation tools like Selenium (POM-Page Object Model, Page Factory), OATS(Oracle Application Testing Suite), QTP (Quick Test Professional)/UFT(Unified Functional Test) and Python (API Automation).
- Strong conceptual and hands-on knowledge in architecting mobile automation frameworks using Appium for Android/iOS.
- Proven ability to implement the shift-left testing strategy, collaborating closely with development teams to incorporate automation early in the process, identify issues in the early stages and improve overall product quality and efficiency.
- Familiar with Behavior-Driven Development (BDD) approach using Cucumber and Gherkin.
- Skilled in managing and mentoring QA teams, supporting continuous learning, fostering a quality culture, guiding junior team members in automation best practices, and generating actionable metrics to improve product quality and team performance.
- Experience in developing and maintaining UI and API automation test scripts for Products and Web Applications.
- Skilled in performing SOAP-based API testing, validating service interactions using XML, and troubleshooting integration issues.
- Hands-on experience in project management and Agile/Scrum product development life cycles
- Proficient in debugging, troubleshooting, identifying root causes and implementing fixes to ensure seamless test execution.
- Working knowledge of test engineering processes and methodologies; Expertise in test planning, test case management, code coverage and defect analysis.
- Hands-on experience with build automation and continuous integration tools, including Git, Jenkins, and Maven
- Experienced in integrating and utilizing EMMA code coverage tool to analyze and improve code coverage for Java applications, ensuring optimal test effectiveness and identifying gaps in test coverage.
- Good understanding of Behavior-Driven Development (BDD) and Test-Driven Development (TDD) practices
- Skilled in delegating tasks effectively based on team strengths and project requirements, to empower teams, ensuring high productivity and seamless execution of quality assurance initiatives.
- Strong knowledge in defining cost-effective and risk-based test strategies to meet business objectives.
- Experience in providing detailed performance review input and development recommendations for individuals and the team.
- Strong analytical and problem-solving skills.
- Ability to work collaboratively with cross-functional teams.
- Actively involved in the recruitment process by conducting technical interviews to assess the practical knowledge and problem solving skills of prospective team members.

EDUCATION

M.S Quality Management, Birla Institute of Technology And Science , Pilani	2008 - 2011
B.Tech Computer Science, Jawaharlal Nehru Technological University , Hyderabad	2001 - 2005

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Test Automation Tools	Selenium Web Driver, Appium, QTP, OATS, Postman, AutoIT, WinRunner
Programming/Scripting Languages	Java, Python, VBScript, Perl
Unit Testing Framework	TestNG
Continuous Integration Tools	Jenkins
Build Tools	Maven
Versioning Tools	GIT, Tortoise SVN, Perforce
Test Management Tools	Jira, QC ALM, Test Link, Oracle Test Manager, Version One
Defect Management Tools	Bug Zilla, Bugs DB
Service Virtualization Tools	DevTest
Data Base	MongoDB, Oracle, SQL Server
Code Review/Coverage Tools	EMMA, Code Collaborator

AWARDS, CERTIFICATIONS & ACHIEVEMENTS

1. 100% hike in salary within 6 months , Interwoven, Bangalore Recognition for exceptional test automation efforts.	Oct 2006
2. Bug Stomper Award , McAfee, Bangalore	June 2009
3. Best Employee Award , McAfee, Bangalore Top performance in consumer projects 2010	2010
4. Best Employee Award , McAfee, Bangalore For extraordinary efforts during 2011	2011
5. Pat on Back Award , EPAM, Hyderabad For tremendous work done for McAfee client	Sept 2013
6. Internal Auditor Training Certification , EPAM, Hyderabad	Jan 2014
7. Pat on Back Award , EPAM, Hyderabad For tremendous work done for McAfee – ITS Automation	April 2014
8. Special Recognition , EPAM, Hyderabad For tremendous work done for McAfee – ITS Automation	June 2014
9. Star of the Quarter , EPAM, Hyderabad	Q2 2014
10. Special Recognition , EPAM, Hyderabad For on time and high-quality delivery – McAfee Test Automation Project	July 2014
11. Managerial Foundation Workshop , EPAM, Hyderabad	2014
12. Pat on Back Award , EPAM, Hyderabad For tremendous work done for Micros-Hospitality project	April 2015
13. Best Team Award , EPAM, Hyderabad Oracle Micros Hospitality Project	Q4 2015
14. Pro-Elevate 2018 , Wells Fargo, Hyderabad Flagship Experiential Leadership Training Program	2018

CORE ATTRIBUTES

- Results-driven mindset with a blend of analytical and design thinking.
- Passion for process improvement, with a keen eye for identifying gaps and implementing solutions.
- Good Communication, Interpersonal and Problem-solving skills.
- Zeal to learn new technologies.
- Strong work commitment, dedication and determination.

EXPERIENCE - BRIEF

1. Techurate Systems Private Limited , Bengaluru Designation: Senior Manager	Feb 2022 – Dec 2023
2. Wells Fargo International Solutions Private Ltd. , Hyderabad Designation: Software Sr. Engineer (Vice President)	Dec 2016 – Dec 2021
3. EPAM Systems India Private Limited , Hyderabad Designation: Lead Software Test Automation Engineer	July 2013 – Dec 2016
4. Wipro Technologies Limited , Hyderabad Designation: Technical Lead.	Jan 2013 – July 2013
5. McAfee Software India Private Limited , Bengaluru Designation: Senior QA Engineer	April 2007 – Dec 2012
6. Interwoven Software Services India Private Limited , Bengaluru (Currently acquired by HP Autonomy, Bangalore) Designation: Consultant Engineer	April 2006 - Mar 2007

EXPERIENCE

Techurate Systems Private Limited Senior Manager Clients: Zanaco Bank, Zambia Projects/Products:	Feb 2022 - Dec 2023
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- Revenue Assurance Application
- Shareholder dividend Payment Application
- Account Migration-Flexcube
- E-Portal

Responsibilities:

- Developed automation strategies and detailed test plans. Created automated test scripts for validating data integrity between source and destination databases as part of the Account Migration Project (Flexcube), effectively identifying and reporting discrepancies while ensuring 100% data integrity.
- Reduced post-migration issues by 30% via proactive automation validation
- Designed and executed SQL queries to extract key data used in generating smart reports for the Revenue Assurance Product.
- Led end-to-end testing efforts, including test planning, execution, and defect lifecycle management. Reviewed test cases to ensure comprehensive coverage, tracked defects to closure, and facilitated triage meetings for timely issue resolution.
- Conducted code reviews to make sure code is maintainable, and adheres to standards. Mentored and supported team members in resolving automation issues and improving technical competency.
- Gathered, reviewed, and analyzed client requirements to ensure alignment with project goals. Provided valuable input to the development team and collaborated with clients to address dependencies and challenges during project execution.
- Developed and maintained project plans and quality KPIs. Identified and mitigated risks early in the cycle to avoid project delays and ensure smooth delivery of milestones.
- Identified and implemented process improvements to streamline QA workflows. Published regular status reports to stakeholders, keeping them informed on progress, metrics, and automation deliverables.
- Managed engineering budgets and optimized resource allocation. Supervised development activities to ensure adherence to timelines and quality benchmarks.

Projects:

- M2 Service Virtualization
- M2 Servicing Migration
- WellFargo Internet Banking Application

Responsibilities:

- Led and mentored a team of 20 engineers in automating and virtualizing 12,000 test scripts from Wells Fargo Internet Banking modules (Accounts, Payments, Servicing) during remote operations in COVID-19; earned a promotion to senior role within 9 months for consistently exceeding expectations.
- Led a team of 15 members responsible for delivering automated test scripts through Shift Left Automation Process for various projects from WIB modules.
- Developed a comprehensive Java-based utility that automates the end-to-end process of creating virtual data, streamlining and accelerating data virtualization workflows.
- Suggested improvements to Shift left automation process which has helped in reducing rework and increasing the productivity by .
- Trained new team members on end-to-end virtual data creation and guided automation best practices.
- Implemented enhancements to Selenium-Java based Web Automation Framework using Page Object Model (POM).
- Developed strong understanding of Service Virtualization, stubbing/mock data creation, and recommended enhancements to the Service Virtualization Portal for improved UX and efficiency.
- Did multiple demonstrations on Service Virtualization to teams from other Line of Business (LoB) and helped them in creating virtual data for their projects.
- Analyzed Splunk logs and SOAP message flows to understand API behavior for Wells Fargo Internet Banking Application features.
- Performed code reviews and string test reviews. Helped team members in resolving automation issues.
- Configured Jenkins pipelines for triggering builds and automated test runs; troubleshoot Jenkins and Git integration issues.
- Estimated efforts, planned automation deliverables, and defined scope for test automation initiatives across multiple projects.
- Facilitated daily stand-ups, sprint planning, and tracked progress via JIRA dashboards.
- Helped Scrum Master in planning and defined user stories, epics, and tasks in JIRA.
- Participated in project meetings and defect triage meetings, and coordinated with functional/data teams to resolve issues related to test cases and test data.
- Published status reports and automation metrics to management, ensuring stakeholders are informed of progress and key metrics.
- Designed effort estimation templates to bring consistency in planning.
- Updated daily status reports and maintained project documentation, KT plans, and remote virtual execution machine details in Confluence.
- Part of the Java and Python interview panel, contributed to hiring across multiple LoBs.

EPAM Systems India Pvt. Ltd. | Lead Software Test Automation Engineer July 2013 - Dec 2016
Projects:

- Oracle - Micros Opera5
- McAfee Consumer - External Defect Regression Suite
- Automation CoE

Responsibilities:

- Designed and developed robust test automation frameworks using Selenium WebDriver (Java) with Page Object Model and Oracle OATS(Oracle Application Testing Suite)
- Did enhancements to METAL(McAfee Easy Test Automation Language) - Python-based framework from McAfee
- Led and mentored a team of 10, coaching junior engineers on test automation and QA best practices
- Accountable for delivering automated tests for multiple projects while adhering to the Agile methodology.
- Conducted Java-Selenium training and helping team members understand automation concepts—driving team productivity and capability building.
- Integrated automated test suites into CI/CD pipelines to ensure continuous testing and validation of code changes, reducing manual intervention, and improving the execution speed.
- Created and implemented automation strategy, effort estimation, and planning, aligning deliverables with Agile practices through sprint planning, backlog grooming, burndown/velocity tracking in JIRA, and client-facing sprint demos.
- Actively participated in backlog grooming sessions to refine and prioritize user stories in JIRA, ensuring alignment with sprint goals and business priorities.
- Drafted technical documentation including Coding Standards, Functional Decomposition Guidelines, and Standard Operating Procedures (SOP) for automation frameworks.
- Configured Oracle Test Manager (OTM) and trained the team on its usage as a test management tool.
- Published automation metrics, tracked automation deliverables and sprint progress.
- Coordinated test suite stabilization activities, ensuring robust and consistent regression results across automation cycles.
- Participated in Java and Python interview panels, helping hire automation engineers with strong Selenium and programming backgrounds for multiple teams.
- Performed Automation Proof-of-Concept (PoC) for Swing-based Java Web Start applications using tools like QF-Test, Robot Framework, and MarathonITE.

Wipro Technologies Limited | Technical Lead Jan 2013 - Jul 2013
Projects:

- Electronic Arts(EA) - Need For Speed - Game

Responsibilities:

- Configuring the Load test environment
- Analysing game/server logs
- Writing scenario's basing on the logs
- Writing and executing stress test scripts
- Analysing the load test results to identify and fix the failures

Projects/Products:

- McAfee Virus Scan Online
- McAfee Sustenance
- McAfee Security Scan
- McAfee Consumer Partner Projects
- McAfee Security Center

Responsibilities:

- Involved in QA activities of McAfee Consumer Virus Scan Product (v12.0 to 16.0), supporting successful rollouts of major, minor releases, and critical patches.
- Mastered automation tools (QTP, Auto IT) and Python from scratch and was recognized as a top performer, trusted by senior leadership to interview and onboard Senior Automation Engineers.
- Led and mentored automation teams on QTP (VBScript), Python, and CTAF, guiding manual testers in their transition to automation roles and enabling successful delivery of test automation deliverables.
- Did enhancements to McAfee's keyword-driven METAL (McAfee Easy Test Automation Language) Framework using Python and CTAF(Consumer Test Automation Framework), contributing significantly to scalable and reusable automation solutions.
- Developed and automated test cases using QTP and Python for various McAfee products, including API automation through reusable libraries created by analyzing product source code.
- Drove automation strategy improvements by identifying gaps, optimizing processes, and suggesting enhancements in planning and execution approaches.
- Streamlined validation for partner customizations using Auto IT and played a key role in automating registry-driven configurations.
- Conducted in-depth training sessions for enterprise QA teams on tools like the EMMA code coverage tool, enabling effective coverage gap identification and resolution.
- Performed automation code reviews and prepared code review checklist to ensure quality and maintainability across the team.
- Led offshore QA teams in multiple projects, coordinated task execution, and ensured timely delivery of automation and testing milestones.
- Took ownership of critical modules (e.g., Quarantine, Email Scan), managed regression test suite updates, and reported progress and metrics to stakeholders.
- Performed test effort estimation, test case optimization, and maintained traceability by linking test failures to defects in tracking tools.
- Authored and executed manual and automated test cases, reviewed PRDs and functional specs, and ensured thorough understanding before automation implementation.
- Participated in exploratory, localization (L10n), compatibility, and competitor product testing; contributed to EIT(Engine Integration Testing), LVT (Live Virus Testing) and GOAT testing for in-depth virus testing validations.
- Handled communication with onsite teams, assigned test cases, and tracked defects to closure while supporting broader QA initiatives across McAfee consumer product lines.

Interwoven Software Services India Private Limited | Consultant Engineer April 2006 - March 2007
Product:

- Interwoven Live Site

Responsibilities:

- Automated 350 test cases using WinRunner and ABT (Action Based Testing) Framework.
- Performed black-box code coverage analysis using EMMA , identifying 15% gap in test coverage.
- Created, executed, and maintained functional and regression test suites.
- Analyse the product issues by going through the application logs and provide the findings in bug reports.
- Logging and tracking defects to closure.